Poorvi · Class 6 English



UNIT 3

Nurturing Nature

7 Neem Baba

8 What a Bird Thought

9 Spices that Heal Us

✨ How to use: read the question, try it yourself first, then check the answer box.

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UNIT 3 · CHAPTER 7

Neem Baba

📖 Let us do these activities before we read

I **A tree is useful to us in many ways. Mention some of these uses.**

✔ ANSWER

Some parts of trees are used in preparing medicines. Trees give us shade, fruits and flowers. Trees give us wood for furniture and paper. Trees give us fresh air and are homes for birds and animals.

II **Discuss in groups and fill: What do you know about the neem tree? What do you want to know?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

What we know: neem leaves are bitter; people clean their teeth with neem twigs; neem gives shade.

What we want to know: How old can a neem tree be? Which diseases can neem help cure?

💬 Let us discuss (Part I)

1 **Fill up the fact sheet ‘Let us know our neem’ based on what Neem Baba told Amber.**

✔ **ANSWER**

Common name: Neem — Given by: the Iranians

Period of birth: millions of years ago

Born at: somewhere in North India or Myanmar

Found in: many Asian and African countries and some parts of America

Common names: Nimb (Hindi), Nim, Leemba, Nimori, Nimbamond, Nimbe, Nimo (Sanskrit names: Arishta, Nimba, Nimbaca)

Names given by scientists: 1. bitter grace of God 2. nature’s gift to man (also ‘cleanliness-parting tree’)

Names given by others: 1. magic tree 2. the tree of the twentieth century

💬 Let us discuss (Part II)

1 **How is neem useful to farmers?**

✔ ANSWER

Neem seed powder mixed in water and sprayed on plants stops locusts from eating them. In rice fields it stops mosquito breeding and helps increase the crop yield. It also saves crops from termites and other insects that eat crops.

2 **Mention some of the uses of the neem tree.**

✔ ANSWER

Neem twigs are used to clean teeth. Neem leaves protect clothes and destroy germs. Leaves, bark, flowers, fruits and roots are used to make medicines. Neem seed powder protects crops and stored grains from insects. Neem oil is used to make soaps and toothpaste. Furniture made of neem wood is not eaten by termites. Neem purifies the air.

🤔 Let us think and reflect

I **Write any two facts about the neem tree that surprised you the most.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

1. The neem tree was born millions of years ago.
2. Neem seed powder in stagnant water stops mosquitoes from breeding.

II **1. Amber played in the shade of _____.**

✔ **ANSWER**

the neem tree in her courtyard

II **2. Neem seed powder protects crops from _____.**

✔ **ANSWER**

locusts, termites and other insects that eat crops

II **3. _____ is a cost-effective method to stop mosquitoes from breeding in stagnant water.**

✔ **ANSWER**

Putting the powder of neem seeds in the stagnant water

II **4. One reason why doctors advise us to use neem leaves for someone suffering from measles is _____.**

✔ ANSWER

neem leaves have chemical properties that destroy germs; they give comfort from itching and do not allow germs to breed

III **Which parts of the neem tree are used to make medicines?**

✔ ANSWER

Neem leaves, bark, flowers, fruits and even roots are used to make medicines.

IV **Why is the story of the neem tree thought-provoking?**

✔ ANSWER

It is thought-provoking because the tree was born in India and given Sanskrit names like Arishta, Nimba and Nimbaca, but the name ‘Neem’ was given by the Iranians. It has many names in India, and it became well known because it is so useful to people.

📘 Let us learn

I **Put the compound words in their trees: something, well known, childhood, neem oil, grandmother, well trained, cleanliness-parting, seed powder, thought-provoking. You may add some more words.**

✔ ANSWER

Open compound words: well known, neem oil, well trained, seed powder (more: ice cream, post office)

Closed compound words: something, childhood, grandmother (more: classroom, sunflower)

Hyphenated compound words: cleanliness-parting, thought-provoking (more: mother-in-law, well-being)

II **Match the verbs in the present with their past forms and make a sentence with any one form.**

✔ **ANSWER**

1. become — (iv) became: I want to become a teacher when I grow up.

2. find — (v) found: I found my lost pen under the table.

3. make — (i) made: My mother made tea for us.

4. discover — (vi) discovered: Amber will discover new uses of neem.

5. tell — (iii) told: Neem Baba told Amber about his names.

6. give — (ii) gave: The Iranians gave the tree the name 'Neem'.

III **Amber speaks to Neem Baba as if speaking to a person. This is called personification. Discuss more examples.**

✔ **ANSWER**

Personification means giving human qualities to non-living things, plants or animals.

Examples: The leaves whispered in the wind. The flowers danced merrily in the breeze. The sun smiled at us. The wind sang a song.

🎧 Let us listen

1 **Listen to a boy speaking to his mother about Peepal Baba and select the correct statements.**

✔ ANSWER

Correct statements: 1, 3 and 4.

1. The mother was surprised to know that Peepal Baba had planted trees all over the country. — Correct

2. The mother disliked the work being done by Peepal Baba. — Not correct (she said he is doing great work)

3. The mother wanted to know more about Peepal Baba. — Correct

4. The boy decided to take care of trees by listening to Peepal Baba's journey. — Correct

5. The boy was worried about what his teacher had told him. — Not correct

🗣️ Let us speak

1 **1–3. Make a leaf card for four dry leaves, speak about how you made it, and ask classmates to identify the leaf and tell one of its uses.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

I collected a dry leaf of the mango tree. I drew its long, pointed shape on the top of the card and coloured it green. Inside, I wrote ‘Mango tree — its leaves are used to make torans for festivals.’ Can you tell me which tree this leaf is from?

✍️ Let us write

1 **Write a paragraph about any one tree in your neighbourhood that you like (where it is, how it looks, why you like it). Give a title.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

My Friend, the Banyan Tree There is a huge banyan tree in the park near my house. It is very tall and has a thick, brown trunk. Many roots hang down from its branches. Its leaves are big, green and shiny. I like it because it gives cool shade on hot afternoons. Many birds and squirrels live in it. Old people sit under it and children play around it. It is a home for many and a friend to all.

Let us explore

1 **Find out which Indian languages these names of neem belong to: Nimb, Nim, Leemba, Nimori, Nimbamond, Nimbe, Nimo.**

✔ ANSWER

Nimb — Hindi (as Neem Baba says in the lesson). Sample (check with your teacher): Nim — Bengali; Leemba — Marathi; Nimbe — Kannada; Nimo, Nimori and Nimbamond — names used in other regional languages and dialects.

🎉 **Chapter 7 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**

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UNIT 3 · CHAPTER 8

What a Bird Thought

📖 Let us do these activities before we read

V **Read the sentences and replace the underlined words with their correct meanings (at last, light, labour, fluttered).**

✔ ANSWER

1. pale — light
2. moved lightly and quickly — fluttered
3. Finally — at last
4. hard work — labour

💬 Let us discuss

I **Identify the main idea of each stanza. (Two sentences are extra.)**

✔ ANSWER

Stanza 1: 2. The bird lived happily in a small world.

Stanza 2: 6. The bird lived in a cosy nest with its mother.

Stanza 3: 1. The bird steps out into the world.

Stanza 4: 4. The bird flies away as an adult.

Extra sentences: 3 and 5.

II **Look at the pictures 1–4 and write the matching line from the poem for each.**

✔ ANSWER

1. (egg) I thought the world was small and round, / And made of pale, blue shell.

2. (bird in nest) I thought the world was made of straw, / And nestled by my mother.

3. (bird on branch among leaves) I said the world is made of leaves,

4. (bird flying) At length I flew beyond the tree,

III **Answer with a word from the poem.**

✔ ANSWER

1. Shape of the bird's first house: ROUND

2. The second nest was made of: STRAW

3. When it came out of its nest it saw: LEAVES

4. At the end the bird: FLEW

IV **Recite the poem aloud along with your teacher and classmates.**

✔ ANSWER

Activity: recite the poem in class.

🤔 Let us think and reflect

1 **I 1. The bird changed its house two times. (True/False)**

✔ **ANSWER**

True (from the shell to the nest, and then beyond the tree).

2 **I 2. The neighbours tell the bird about the world. (True/False)**

✔ **ANSWER**

False. The neighbours also do not know how the world is made.

II **1(i). Who lived in the nest along with the baby bird?**

✔ **ANSWER**

Its mother lived in the nest with the baby bird.

II **1(ii). The bird thought the world was made of straw because _____.**

✔ **ANSWER**

B. its nest was made of straw

II **1(iii). Which word tells us that the baby bird was warm and comfortable?**

✔ ANSWER

nestled

II **2(i). Why did the bird think the world was made of leaves?**

✔ ANSWER

When it fluttered out of its nest, it saw leaves all around it, so it thought the world was made of leaves.

II **2(ii). What does the set of words 'I said' mean?**

✔ ANSWER

C. spoke

II **2(iii). The bird felt that it had been very blind because it could not __ __ __ the leaves from __n__ __ __e the nest.**

✔ ANSWER

The bird felt that it had been very blind because it could not see the leaves from inside the nest.

III **Why did the baby bird think that its first world was small, round and blue?**

✔ **ANSWER**

Its first home was the egg. The egg was small and round, and its shell was pale blue. So the bird thought the world was small, round and blue.

IV **Where did the bird go when it fluttered from its straw nest?**

✔ **ANSWER**

It came out of the nest onto the branches of the tree, among the leaves, to see what it could find.

V **What quality did the bird say it had, when it flew away?**

✔ **ANSWER**

It said it was grown up and ‘quite fit for grown-up labours’, that is, strong enough to do grown-up work.

VI **Who do you think were the bird's neighbours? Why do you think so? Discuss.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

The bird's neighbours were the other birds and creatures living on the tree and around it. They lived near the bird, and like the bird, they also did not know how big the world is.

📘 Let us learn

I **Write the rhyming words from each stanza and add new rhyming words.**

✔ **ANSWER**

Stanza 1: well, shell — new: fell (also bell, sell)

Stanza 2: other, mother — new: brother

Stanza 3: find, blind — new: kind (also mind)

Stanza 4: labours, neighbours — new: favours (also flavours)

I **Complete the new stanza: I fly high and I fly low, / But one thing I surely k___, / Whenever I wish to rest, / My little nest is the ___t.**

✔ **ANSWER**

I fly high and I fly low, But one thing I surely know, Whenever I wish to rest, My little nest is the best.

II **Use the describing words (pointed, green, thin, brown, small, wooden, hanging, round) to create six sentences based on the picture.**

✔ **ANSWER**

1. The birdhouse is wooden.
2. The birdhouse is hanging from a thin branch.
3. It has a pointed red roof.
4. The birdhouse has a round door.
5. A small brown bird is sitting outside it.
6. There are green leaves on the branch.

🎧 Let us listen

1 **Listen to the poem and fill in the missing words.**

✔ **ANSWER**

My feathers are bright and they glow. Fly around and see wonderful things. Come with me through the skies so blue, Among the trees, where the breeze is light, Many new stories, oh, what a sight!

🗣️ Let us speak

1 **Speak about which bird you would like to be (which bird, how you look, where you live, what you do, your message for humans).**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

I am a parrot. I am green in colour. I am a small bird. I have a red, curved beak. I live in a hole in a tall tree. It is in a park near a school. I fly around and eat fruits and seeds during the day. I also talk and copy sounds. I want to tell the humans, 'Please do not cut trees and do not keep us in cages.'

✍️ Let us write

1 **II–III. Discuss how the world would look to 1. a baby and 2. a fish. Write five sentences for each.**

✔ **ANSWER**

Sample — 1. A baby: My world is my mother's lap. It is soft and warm. I see my family's smiling faces. I hear sweet songs and voices. Slowly my world grows bigger as I learn to crawl and walk. Sample — 2. A fish: My world is made of water. It is cool and blue. I see plants, stones and other fish around me. I swim up and down all day. I do not know what lies outside the water.

Let us explore

I **Look at your home: list the materials it is made of. Why are our homes not made of straw? What would your dream home look like? How is a home different from a house?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

My home is made of bricks, cement, sand, iron rods, wood, glass and paint. Our homes are not made of straw because straw is weak. It can catch fire, get wet in rain and blow away in strong wind. My dream home would have a garden, big windows and solar panels. I would use bricks, wood and glass. A house is a building made of bricks and cement. A home is a house where a family lives together with love and care.

I Find out the work done by workers who build houses.

✔ ANSWER

Example: mason — lays bricks and stones

1. painter — paints the walls and doors
2. electrician — fixes wires, switches, lights and fans
3. plumber — fixes water pipes, taps and tanks
4. carpenter — makes doors, windows and furniture from wood
5. architect — plans and designs the house
6. Sample: welder — joins iron gates and grills
7. Sample: tile setter — fixes tiles on floors and walls

II Look at the different kinds of nests and homes birds make. Discuss.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The weaver bird weaves a hanging nest of grass. The tailor bird stitches leaves together. The woodpecker makes a hole in a tree trunk. The crow builds a nest of twigs. Sparrows make nests in holes in walls.

🎉 Chapter 8 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.

UNIT 3 · CHAPTER 9

9 Spices that Heal Us

📖 Let us do these activities before we read

I **Recall the names of three spices used for cooking in your home.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

1. turmeric (haldi) 2. cumin seeds (jeera) 3. black pepper (kali mirch)

II **Write what you call these spices in your language.**

✔ **ANSWER**

1. Turmeric — haldi
2. Fenugreek — methi
3. Cumin seeds — jeera
4. Asafoetida — heeng
5. Cinnamon — dalchini
6. Clove — laung
7. Ginger — adrak
8. Black pepper — kali mirch
9. Fennel seeds — saunf
10. Cardamom — elaichi

🤔 Let us think and reflect

1 **I 1. Where exactly in the kitchen did her grandmother find the cures?**

✔ **ANSWER**

She found the cures in the spices kept in the kitchen.

2 **I 2. Give one example of weather-related common illnesses.**

✔ **ANSWER**

Cough and cold.

3 **I 3. What kind of relationship did the speaker have with her grandmother?**

✔ **ANSWER**

She had a close and loving relationship with her grandmother. She learnt the home remedies from her.

II **Daadi soaked methi seeds overnight and drank the water in the morning to manage _____ and _____.**

✔ **ANSWER**

her sugar level and her body weight

III **Circle the spice that is not useful for body pain according to Daadi's letter: Turmeric, Fennel seeds, Ginger, Black pepper.**

✔ ANSWER

2. Fennel seeds (they help in digestion).

IV **Why did Daadi ask Vikram and Vaibhavi to share the natural cures with their friends?**

✔ ANSWER

The natural cures had helped them get better, so Daadi wanted their friends to know these useful cures and benefit from them too.

V **What was Daadi's final advice to Vikram and Vaibhavi?**

✔ ANSWER

She asked them to go into the kitchen and identify the herbs and spices, and to always consult an elder before using them.

VI **How do we know that natural cures are passed from one generation to another?**

✔ ANSWER

Daadi learnt the cures from her grandmother when she was a child, and now she is passing them on to her grandchildren, Vikram and Vaibhavi.

VII **Why do you think we should know about the healing properties of spices?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Spices are easily found in our kitchen. If we know their healing properties, we can get relief from common problems like cough, cold and indigestion. But we must use them only after asking an elder, and see a doctor when we are really ill.

📘 Let us learn

I **Complete the table (part of the plant, colour, texture, taste) for the spices.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Turmeric — root — yellow — rough — bitter
Fenugreek — seeds — yellowish-brown — rough — bitter Cinnamon — bark — brown — rough — sweet Clove — flower buds — dark brown — rough — spicy Black pepper — fruit — black — rough — spicy Cardamom — fruit/seeds — green — soft — sweet

II **1. Match the helping verbs (modals) in Column A with their functions in Column B.**

✔ **ANSWER**

(i) may — b. suggestion
(ii) should — d. advice
(iii) can — e. ability
(iv) must — c. compulsion
(v) need to — f. necessity
(vi) used to — a. past habit

II **2. Complete the dialogues with any four modals (use a modal only once).**

✔ ANSWER

Ajay: Anand had fever last week. He (i) should take good rest.

Suman: Yes, he (ii) must or he will fall ill again.

Ajay: He (iii) can take grandmother's natural cures.

Suman: Yes, we (iv) need to remember how effective they are.

🎧 Let us listen

1 **Listen to the benefits of Tulsi and complete the fact sheet 'The Wonder Herb'.**

✔ ANSWER

1. Name: Tulsi — Family: basil
2. First found in: north central India
3. Now found: everywhere in India
4. Known as: the Queen of herbs
5. Can decrease levels of: glucose and cholesterol
6. Used to treat disorders of: breathing and digestion
7. Is used to make: mouth wash and toothpaste
8. We can have Tulsi leaves by: eating them raw or adding them while making tea

🗣️ Let us speak

1 **1–3. Introduce yourself as a spice to the class, wearing a spicy headband (name, part of the plant, colour, texture, taste, benefits).**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Hello friends! I am Cinnamon. In Hindi you call me dalchini. I am the bark of a tree. I am brown in colour and rough to touch. I taste sweet. I give relief from toothache till you can see a dentist, and I make your food smell lovely.

✍ Let us write

I **Help Vikram complete the natural cures for cough using the phrases in the box (two phrases are not needed).**

✔ **ANSWER**

1. First, take a piece of fresh ginger, grate it and take the juice from it. ... Warm the mixture slightly on very low heat for a minute. Then you can have it about three to four times a day to get relief from cough. ... natural cures for cough with ginger and honey might take some time to show results.

2. To prepare the second home remedy for cough, ... Add four to six small cardamoms and grind to get a fine powder. If you take this powder with an equal amount of honey, it will give you relief from cough.

Phrases not needed: some leaves of basil; for high fever.

II **Write a short paragraph on Tulsi based on the completed fact sheet.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Tulsi is a wonder herb of the basil family. It was first found in north central India, and now it grows almost everywhere in India. It is called 'the Queen of herbs'. It helps to decrease glucose and cholesterol levels. It is used to treat breathing and digestion problems. Tulsi is used to make mouth wash and toothpaste. We can eat its leaves raw or add them to tea.

🔭 Let us explore

I **Guess the spices from the riddles.**

✔ **ANSWER**

1. Asafoetida (heeng) — granny put heeng water on the tummy to give relief.
2. Ginger (adrak) — it grows under the ground, has been used for over 4000 years, is used daily in cooking and helps cure cold.

II **1. Fill in the blanks: Brownish-____ in colour, and ____ to taste, I help everyone, to ____ their weight. (Ans: Fenugreek)**

✔ ANSWER

Brownish-yellow in colour, and bitter to taste, I help everyone, to control their weight.

II **2. Write another riddle of your own about a spice.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

I am small and green, / I hide seeds within, / I make your sweets smell nice / And your breath fresh and clean. / Who am I? (Ans: Cardamom — elaichi)

III **Close your eyes and learn about spices by smelling and feeling them.**

✔ ANSWER

Activity: done in class with spices provided by the teacher.

🎉 **Chapter 9 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**